25901371 MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP(HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026

FOURTH SMESTER

DISCIPLINE SPECIFIC COURSE (DSC)-MG4DSCLIH200- MOODS OF MODERNISM AND POETICS OF THE POSTMODERN: MAKERS OF ENGLISH LITERATURE.

(2024 Admission Onwards)

Duration: 2 hrs **Max. Marks: 70**

SCHEME OF VALUATION

PART A - MCQ
Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 mark

1. b) Ezra Pound (CO1)

2. b) the Abbey Theatre (CO1)

3. a) C.S Lewis (CO2)

4. c) The United States and the Soviet Union (CO2)

5. b) The separation of thought and feeling in poetry (CO2)

6. b) World War II (CO3)

7. b) Postmodernism (CO3)

8. b) Expose patriarchal assumptions (CO3)

9. d) Non-English works (CO4)

10. c) Hilary Mantel (CO4)

(1x10=10)

PART B - SHORT ANSWERS
Answer any 6 questions. Each question carries 5 marks.

11. Siegfried Sassoon-His collection, Counter-Attack exposes the visceral horror, strategic incompetence and futility of trench warfare through direct, unflinching language- savagely condemns the older generation of officers who sent young men to die – he issued a public protest in 1917, declaring the war a "senseless slaughter." Sassoon's voice of outrage and moral clarity gave war poetry a new, searing honesty—a refusal to glorify and a demand for accountability. (CO1)

12. King Edward VII – The Edwardian (1901-1910)-London became a lively centre of fashion, art and diplomacy. Britain seemed strong and successful, full of optimism and

imperial pride-Political change-reduced inequality-Women's Suffrage and Social Change-Modernist experimentation in literature. (CO 1)

13. The period between 1918 -1945 was one of the most turbulent and transformative eras-witnessed dramatic political, social and economic upheavals that reshaped nations, undermined old certainties -influenced the course of modern literature and art- Experiences of mass warfare, displacement, economic collapse -political extremism – questioning of long-standing values - to explore new ways of seeing the world-Modernism, emerged during this period . (CO2)

14. Sean O' Casey - known for his poetic realism and strong social awareness - major figure of the Abbey dramatists, he transformed Irish theatre through his vivid portrayals of working-class Dublin life shaped by poverty and political conflict- blending realism, lyricism and tragicomedy combined humour with pathos and social critique with compassion. His notable plays The Shadow of a Gunman (1923), Juno and the Paycock (1924) and The Plough and the Stars (1926). (CO2)

15. W H Auden - leading voice of the second generation of modernists-was marked by intellectual versatility, stylistic innovation - a deep engagement with moral and social issues. Auden's Poems (1930) and The Orators (1932), reveal the explore themes of psychology, politics and personal crisis.
(CO2)

16. Alan Sillitoe's foundational text - Angry Young Men movemen t- constitutes a raw, anarchic philosophy of resistance against the "grind" of industrial monotony and authority- portrayed working class life-realistic-introduction of anti-hero-new path in British fiction. (CO3)

17. Class distinctions - Gender issues - Racial problems-Immigration-Rebellion of youth-Rigid social structures. (CO3)

18. Shaped by Linton Kwesi Johnson-Benjamin Zephania- introduced the rhythms of reggae and the politics -fused Jamaican poetry—a performance-based form addressing race, class, policing and state violence employed performance poetry to advocate social justice, racial equality, anti-racism and animal rights. (CO4)

19. Consistently interrogates migration, colonial -Her acclaimed works-Lions and Tigers, Sugar Mummies- Gladiator Games -explore themes of gender, migration, exploitation and historical memory- reimagines canonical texts from postcolonial and feminist perspective-a leading voice in contemporary British drama that centres multicultural experience and challenges dominant narratives of history and identity. (CO4)

(5x6=30)

PART C - ESSAY

Answer any 2 questions. Each question carries 15 marks

20. The signifier- the sound-image or written form of a word-the signified: the mental concept or meaning it evokes -the relationship between the signifier and the signified is arbitrary-Meaning, is not inherent but arises from difference within the language system. Language is a network of contrasting relations. Saussure also made a key distinction between: Langue: The underlying, shared system of a language—its grammar,rules and vocabulary—that exists collectively among speakers-Parole-the individual act of speaking or writing.

(CO1)

21. An age of rapid industrialisation, scientific advancement, urban expansion and shifting moral values- novelists sought new narrative techniques -reflect a fragmented, uncertain modern reality-Traditional plots, chronological narratives and objective description were frequently replaced by experimental forms, multiple perspectives and symbolic or impressionistic styles- the stream-of-consciousness technique -Writers such as James Joyce, Virginia Woolf and D. H. Lawrence transformed the possibilities of fiction by probing themes of identity, sexuality, class conflict, personal freedom and the search for meaning in an unstable world. Aldous Huxley, George Orwell and Graham Greene - extended the scope of modern fiction by examining the ethical, political and social crises of the twentieth century through dystopian visions, political allegory and morally complex narratives. (CO2)

22. “Movement” represents a distinctive postwar British sensibility- Philip Larkin, Elizabeth Jennings, Donald Davie, Kingsley Amis and Thom Gunn - shared temperament -championed restraint, precision and modesty -textures of contemporary life-employs regular metre, lucid syntax and argument over atmosphere shifting class structures, a weakening imperial identity and new patterns of work and belief affected the individual’s sense of continuity. (CO3)

23. Cool Britannia described the mid-1990s cultural moment when British music, art and theatre projected a new confidence. Tony Blair -modernisation and cultural renewal-reimagining of national identity -Cool Britannia offered style rather than substance-mirroring New Labour’s own emphasis on presentation over radical change-literature - Zadie Smith, Monica Ali and Nick Hornby examined multicultural life, urban alienation and the search for belonging. (CO4)

(15 x 2 = 30)